



Q&A Special

Agent 001 answers all your
buying queries

Graphics card purchase tips

I need your help in making up my mind before buying myself a graphics card. I use my machine primarily for gaming and want to upgrade only my GPU to a DX 11 model. At the same time, I don't want a very expensive card as my system config is outdated. I'm looking at a price range of ₹7,000 to ₹9,000.

Is ATI Radeon HD 5770 a good choice or should I opt for a Geforce GTX 460 series card? My config is as follows: Intel Core 2 Duo E8400 @ 3.00 GHz, ASUS P5Q - E, Transcend 3 x 2 GB Ram @ 800 MHz, Seagate 2 x 500 GB HDD, CoolerMaster eXtreme Power Plus 600 W, XFX 8800 GT - Alpha Dog Edition, Samsung 2233 SW Monitor

Jayesh Potdar

A The GeForce GTX460 is the faster of the two cards, and I would recommend going for it. Look for overclocked AMP! models from ZOTAC or ASUS's TOP models.

While it's a valid concern, your processor should not be too much of a bottleneck. Just make sure you run games at higher resolutions and with FSAA turned on.

New power supply for upgrade?

My system configuration is as follows: Intel Core i3-530, Intel DH55TC motherboard, Kingston 2 GB DDR3 RAM, Samsung 80 GB HDD, Seagate 500 GB HDD, XFX 9400GT 1GB, LG DVD Writer, Foxin ATX 400 W PSU (No 6 pin connector). I am planning to upgrade my system with a GTX460 or GTS450 card. I want to know what PSU I would need to run the system.

Ayan Bhattacharya

A Look for the Corsair VX450. It's a stable power supply that should be



The Corsair VX450 is a reliable 450W PSU

sufficient for pretty much any system running a single upper mid-range graphics card.

Suggestions for graphics card

My PC has the following configuration: Compaq Presario desktop, RAM - 512 MB DDR2, Motherboard - Intel, Monitor - BenQ 17-inch

Currently, I'm using Windows Vista Business service pack 2. I have a budget of ₹6,000. Please suggest an ATI graphics card. I also have a few questions: What is a chipset? What are its uses? How can one increase browsing, download and upload speed?

Jack Krauser

A The system configuration you have mentioned isn't complete, and it also looks pretty outdated. If you're looking to add a graphics card to play PC games, then I would suggest against it. You need to upgrade the rest of the components before upgrading the graphics card.

A bunch of chips that work hand-in-hand can be called a chipset. Motherboards normally have chipsets. If you are looking for a basic graphics card for desktop use, then look for a GeForce 8400GS, or a Radeon 4350 if you're particularly looking for an AMD card.

Your internet connection speed depends completely on your service provider. There is little you can do to speed it up.

PC upgrade queries

The thing is, I just bought an AOC 18.5 inch LCD monitor. The maximum resolution supported is 1366x768. Currently I am using an Athlon X26000+ with 9500GT. Now, most of the latest games are turning out to be too much for my system to handle. It's time I upgrade my system. I thought of the ASUS M4n68t-m DDR3 motherboard with Corsair 4 GB 1333 MHz RAM. For my CPU, I was contemplating the Phenom II 550. Buying all these leaves me around 7000 INR for my graphics card. Please suggest a good one and also suggest whether my processor upgrade is okay or not. My PSU is 500 W and has a PCI-E power connector.

Soumyajit Ganguly

A Look for a Biostar or a Gigabyte AMD785G or 880G-based chipset motherboard. The Phenom 2 555 BE is highly overclockable, and it would be a better option. A Radeon 5750 from XFX or ASUS should fit your budget just fine. The 500 W power supply should run the new graphics card without any problems.

Mobile phone around Rs. 20,000

I want to buy a mobile phone for around ₹20,000. I have shortlisted two phones - Nokia XpressMusic 5800 and N97 mini. Can you suggest which one of the two would be better for multimedia purposes?

Chadan Bora

A Nokia Express Music is available under ₹12,000 and N97 mini is around ₹19,000. Features wise both are quite similar except in the camera department; where N97 has a 5MP camera and 5800 has a 3.15 MP one. The major difference however is that N97 has a slide-out full QWERTY keypad while 5800 is complete resistive touchscreen.

Going by value for money, we feel Nokia 5800 makes more sense unless you like the hardware keypad. Other features are quite similar like support for WiFi, same processor etc.